

Strengthening the Prevention and Response to Sexual and Gender-Based Violence in Migori County

Accelerating the Implementation of County SGBV Policies and Strengthening Survivor-Centred Services

Executive Summary

Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV) continues to undermine the health, safety, dignity and socio-economic wellbeing of women, girls, men and boys across Migori County. Migori County has demonstrated strong political commitment to addressing SGBV through the adoption of the Migori County SGBV Policy (2019), Implementation Strategy (2023–2028), and the Migori County Gender Equality Act. However, harmful social norms, limited implementation capacity, and gaps in service delivery persist.

Despite existing legal frameworks, structured coordination mechanisms, trained service providers and survivor-centred interventions, funding, institutionalization and community engagement remain critical bottlenecks. This advocacy brief outlines key policy and implementation gaps in Migori County and proposes priority interventions to strengthen the county's response to SGBV and advance the rights, protection and dignity of survivors.

Why This Matters

SGBV is not just a violation of human rights, it is a barrier to development, equality and justice. Strengthening prevention and response systems in Migori County is essential to:



Protect Rights and Dignity

Ensuring every survivor's right to safety, justice, health and psychosocial support.



Advance Gender Equality

Challenging harmful norms and promoting equality for women, girls, men and boys.



Strengthen Systems

Building institutional capacity and coordination to deliver timely, quality and survivor-centred services.



Build Safer and Stronger Communities

Empowering communities to prevent violence and support survivors with compassion and respect.



By closing policy and implementation gaps, Migori County can create a future where every individual lives free from violence and has the opportunity to thrive.

County Legal & Policy Landscape

Migori County has a set of key laws, policies and instruments for addressing Sexual and Gender-Based Violence. The priority is now implementation.

Policy/Framework	Status	Key Provisions	Current Challenges
Migori County SGBV Policy (2019)	Adopted	Provides a county framework for preventing and responding to SGBV, promoting multi-sectoral coordination, survivor rights, prevention and institutional strengthening.	Implementation gaps, limited resources and weak coordination.
Migori County SGBV Strategy (2023–2028)	Adopted	Promotes gender equality, builds institutional capacity, and aligns with national policies (GBV Act 2006) and the constitution.	Implementation delays, insufficient enforcement and financing.
Draft Migori County Gender Equality Act (Under Review)	Drafting Stage	Strengthens county coordination, prevention and response to SGBV and other violations, including emerging forms of GBV.	Pending review, approval and adoption.
Kenya Constitution (2010)	Enacted	Guarantees equality, dignity, freedom from discrimination and protection from all forms of violence.	Weak enforcement mechanisms, access, social norms.
Sexual Offences Act (2006) & Anti-GBV Acts	Enacted	Provides legal definitions, rights of survivors and prescribes penalties for SGBV offences.	Limited budget allocation for implementation.
National Policy on SGBV (2014)	Active	Provides a national framework for prevention and response with county implementation mandates.	Partial domestication and limited county implementation.

Current Implementation Gaps

Although Migori County has established an enabling policy environment, several implementation challenges continue to limit impact.

- ✓ Inadequate resources for meaningful roll-out of the County SGBV Implementation Strategy and Gender Equality Act.
- ✓ Delayed review, approval and adoption of the Draft Gender Equality Act.
- ✓ Weak enforcement mechanisms, access, safety limitations.
- ✓ Limited budget allocation for implementation of SGBV programmes.
- ✓ Persistent cultural norms and stigma that discourage reporting and support services.
- ✓ Insufficient awareness, training for duty bearers and service providers.
- ✓ Fragmented coordination among key actors and weak community linkages.

Priority Advocacy Actions

Priority Area	Lead Institution	Recommended Advocacy Action	Expected Outcome
Resource Mobilization and Policy Funding	Department of Gender, County Treasury, County Assembly Gender Caucus, Donors	Develop and advocate for county budget allocations for SGBV implementation and survivor-centred services aligned to County Policy (2019–2026).	Increased prioritisation of funding for SGBV programmes.
Fast Track Adoption of the Draft Gender Equality Act	County Executive, County Assembly, Speaker's Office	Complete policy review, stakeholder validation and expedite approval of the Gender Equality Act (2020).	Strengthened and enforced gender equality laws and policies.
Increase County Resource Allocation	County Treasury, County Assembly	Establish dedicated budget allocations for SGBV prevention, survivor services, awareness creation and capacity building.	Sustainable funding for SGBV programmes.
Strengthen Multi-Sectoral Services	Department of Health, Gender, Social Services, Police, Social Service Providers	Strengthen coordination among health, legal and social service providers to improve service delivery.	Improved access to quality survivor-centred services.
Improve Data Systems and Monitoring	Department of Gender, M&E Unit, County ICT	Strengthen data systems for SGBV protection, justice, police, health sectors, and institutional monitoring.	More coordinated evidence-based decision-making.
Strengthen Community Awareness and Engagement	Department of Gender, Education, CBOs, Faith Leaders, Youth Groups	Conduct county-wide awareness campaigns on SGBV prevention, reporting channels and survivor rights.	Increased community ownership and reporting of SGBV incidents.
Strengthen Monitoring and Accountability	Speaker's Office, Standing Committees, Independent Monitoring Unit	Develop county implementation indicators, strengthen monitoring mechanisms and implementation reviews of all SGBV initiatives.	Improved accountability and evidence-based planning.



County Implementation Scorecard

Implementation Area	Current Status	Priority Action
 Migori County SGBV Policy (2019)	 Low implementation status	Strengthen implementation and enforcement.
 Migori County Gender Policy (2021–2028)	 Low implementation status	Accelerate implementation and coordination.
 Draft GBV Policy (2026)	 Pending adoption	Fast track review and formal adoption.
 County Budget Allocation	 Low	Establish dedicated budget lines for SGBV programmes.
 Survivor Support Services	 Moderate	Strengthen referral pathways and comprehensive survivor care.
 Multi-sectoral Coordination	 Moderate	Improve coordination across county sectors.
 Community Awareness	 Low	Expand prevention and safe stigma campaigns.
 Monitoring & Accountability	 Low	Strengthen monitoring systems and annual implementation reviews.

County Implementation Roadmap

Priority Action	Lead Institution	Timeline
 Develop implementation plan for the Migori County SGBV Policy (2019) and Gender Policy (2021–2028).	Department of Gender	Immediate (0–6 months)
 Complete review, validation and adoption of the Draft Migori County Gender-Based Violence Policy (2026).	County Executive, County Assembly	0–6 months
 Integrate SGBV priorities into County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP), Annual Development Plans (ADPs) and annual budgets.	Department of Gender, County Treasury	Annual planning cycle
 Establish dedicated county budget lines for SGBV prevention and survivor support.	County Treasury, County Assembly	Annual budgeting cycle
 Strengthen county-wide survivor referral systems and integrated survivor services.	Department of Health, Department of Gender	6–12 months
 Conduct county-wide awareness campaigns on SGBV prevention, PSEA protocols and survivor rights.	Department of Gender, Community Health Services, CSOs	Continuous
 Conduct annual implementation reviews and publish county progress reports.	Department of Gender, Monitoring & Evaluation Unit	Annual



Migori County has already established a strong policy foundation for preventing and responding to Sexual and Gender-Based Violence. The priority now is to translate these policies into meaningful action that protects survivors, prevents violence and strengthens accountability.